

THE WHEEL WHISPERER

For Manan Shah, Managing Director of MICL Group, luxury cars are not about showcasing one's wealth or status. It is about personal well-being

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WHILE AUTOMOBILES ARE commonly seen as a means of transport, there exists a select group for whom they embody a fusion of design, prowess, and refinement. Manan Shah, Managing Director of real estate major MICL Group, belongs to the latter category. For him, the allure of owning a luxury vehicle springs from a desire to immerse himself in unparalleled experiences every day. Shah has owned more than 20 luxury cars over the past decade, and his current fleet includes four icons: the Bentley Bentayga, the Porsche Panamera, the Range Rover Vogue, and the Mercedes-Benz G-Class, popularly called the G-Wagon.

“Living, as we do, in crowded cities where we are compelled to



spend hours in traffic, our daily commute can make a significant impact on our wellbeing. That's where luxury cars truly shine,” explains Shah.

For him, the very concept of automotive luxury is tied to the notion of personal well-being. Each of his vehicles boasts of double-insulated glass, skillfully engineered to cocoon the interior from external clamour, fostering an oasis of tranquility within. This isolation enhances his commute, whether he's immersed in watching a movie inside his car or luxuriating in the embrace of massage seats.

Given Shah's busy schedule and the crowded Mumbai roads, his rides during the day are chauffeur-driven. But he enjoys his collection personally during the evenings and on weekends. His most cherished memory involves driving his G-Wagon, his second car from the same make, and he fondly calls it an ongoing “love affair”.

“I've taken my G-Wagon on some remarkable journeys, including from Mumbai to [Vadodara]. What makes these drives so special is the scenic beauty along the way,” he says. Shah recalls that back in 2014-15, when G-Wagons